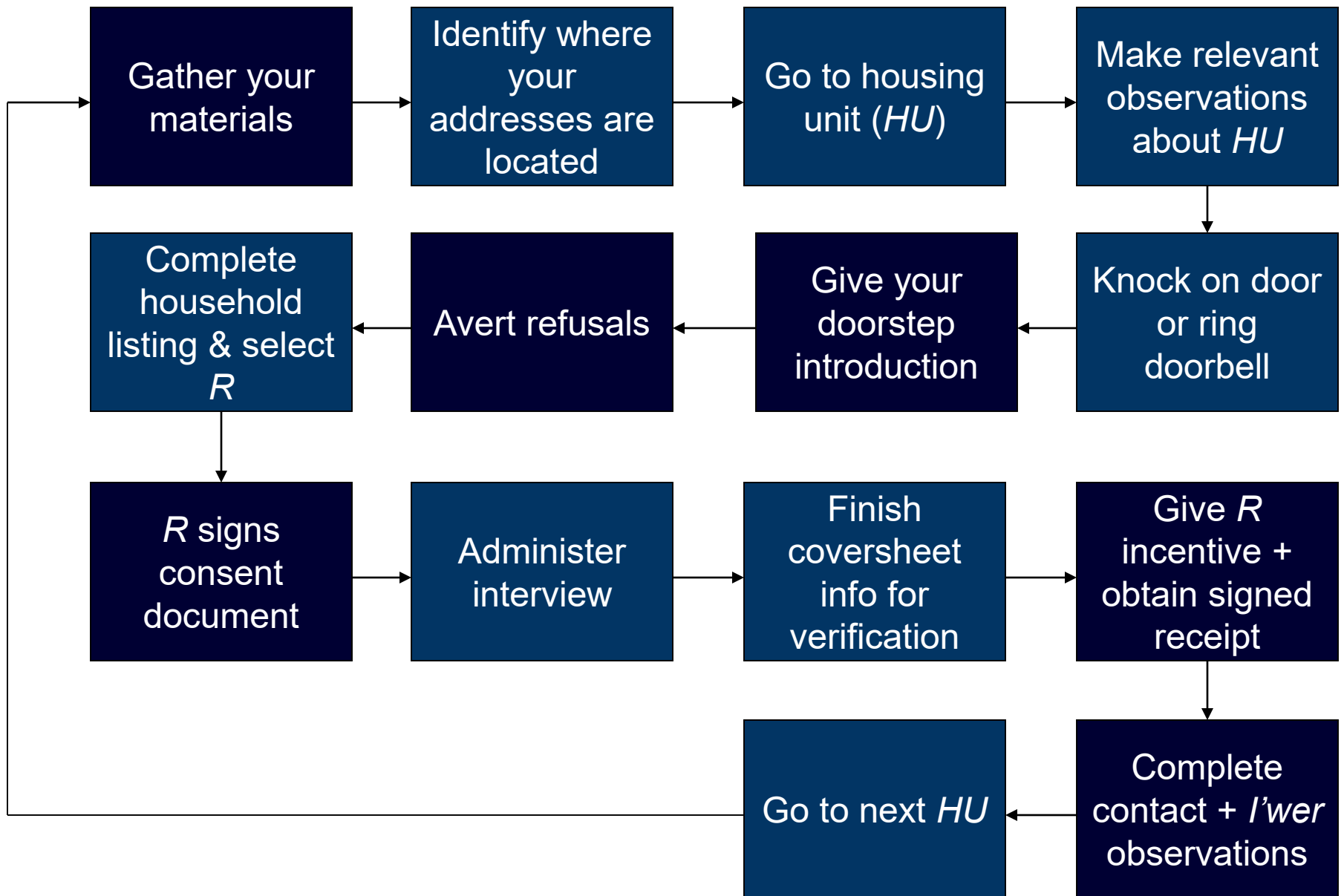


Outline of Today's Class

- Lecture on Doorstep Introductions and Refusal Aversion Strategies

Overview of the Interviewing Process

- Review of the interview process
- Getting ready for interviews
 - Materials and other things to remember
- Doorstep introductions
- Refusal aversion techniques
- Administering consents
- Issuing respondent payments
- Filling out call records



Overview

- Review of the interview process
- Getting Ready for interviews
 - Materials and other things to remember
- Doorstep introductions
- Refusal aversion techniques
- Administering consents
- Issuing respondent payments
- Filling out call records

Gaining Cooperation vs. Administering the Questionnaire

***Q'naire* administration**

- Standardized
- Same stimulus for all *HHs/Rs*
- Focused on minimizing measurement error

Cooperation

- Flexible
- Tailored
- Conversational
- Dynamic
- Focused on minimizing the risk for nonresponse bias

Getting in the Door

- You have to convince R that you are
 - Professional
 - Legitimate
 - Collecting important information
 - R is crucial to success of study
- How do you do that?

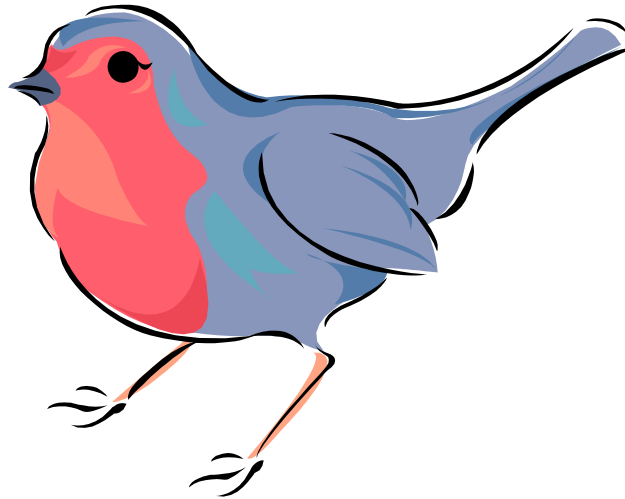
Be Ready!

- Have a doorstep introduction ready:
 - Who are you and why are you there?
 - Show your badge (ID in your ID holder) when you say *"University of Michigan"*

Hi, my name is _____, and I'm a student from the University of Michigan. We are doing a research study on people's life and general attitudes on various topics. The survey will take about 20 minutes. I was hoping that this would be a convenient time for you.

Round Robin Doorstep Introduction Practice

- Give your doorstep introduction to your partner (the one who sits next to you)
 - Reading suggested statement
 - Without reading suggested statement



The Approach: Attitude

- Approach each household as if they are friendly and cooperative
 - Most households will be!
 - If they aren't, generally they just don't know why you are there
 - It is NOT you! Don't take it personally!
 - Confidence matters!
- Be prepared to answer questions
 - Be familiar with the Frequently Asked Questions (FAQs) before you go out the door
- Don't ask a question that can be answered with "No"
 - *"Is this a good time for you?"*
 - *"I was hoping that now would be a convenient time."*

Overview

- Review of the interview process
- Getting Ready for interviews
 - Materials and other things to remember
- Doorstep introductions
- Refusal aversion techniques
- Administering consents
- Issuing respondent payments
- Filling out call records

Averting Refusals

- Some *HHs* will resist participation
 - People don't expect strangers on their doorstep
 - Can catch people at a bad time
 - They don't know why you're there
 - It's not you, it's the survey
- Converting refusals vs. averting refusals
 - We used to train to convert refusals
 - *R* already refused, how do we 'convert' them
 - Corrective in nature
 - Now, we train to 'avert' refusal
 - Stop potential refusals!
 - Preventive in nature

5 Steps for Encouraging Survey Response

1. Prepare for interaction
2. Engage in active listening to keep conversation going
3. Diagnose main concern
4. Select a response to main concern
5. Quickly address the concern

Step 1 - Prepare for Interaction

- **Observe characteristics** of *HU* (e.g., evidence of children, no trespassing signs) in order to anticipate and better understand concerns informant or *R* might have about participating in pretest

Step 2 - Engage in 'Active Listening'

- Once in contact with *R* or informant your job is to **keep conversation going** to discover what concerns they might have about you and survey
- **Carefully listen** to *R*, what they say, when they say it, tone of voice used, body language, what is going on around *R*, etc.
- The **longer the conversation** you can have, the **greater the chances** that you will get to know concerns of *R*

Step 3 - Diagnose Main Concern

- **Identify concern** that is most likely keeping them from participating
- In theory, you are identifying the “why”
 - **Why** doesn't *R* want to participate immediately?

Step 4 - Select Response

- **Quickly identify response** that appropriately addresses main source of reluctance identified in Step 3
- Having a **large and ready supply** of responses to match various sources of reluctance will improve your success
- Here, you are identifying the “what”
 - **What** can I share with the respondent about study that addresses concern about participating?

Step 5 - Quickly Address Concern

- **Immediately and articulately deliver** counter response, addressing *R's* concern
- Delivery must happen **quickly**, and content of response should be concise and relevant
- With this statement you are **addressing concern** identified in Step 3
- **Process continues** as you hear, diagnose, and address each concern

So, what do you actually say???



Example 1: Preparing for Interaction

- *HH* composition cues
 - Evidence of who may live there can be easily observed as you approach
 - Do you see children's toys in yard, bicycles in driveway, multiple cars in driveway, or persons standing outside home?
- Privacy cue
 - You may see signs such as 'No Trespassing' or 'No Soliciting', privacy doors, and remote access keypads, or see curtain drawn at a particular residence
 - All of these indicators tell you that privacy is a concern for this household

Concerns

- Bad timing
- Burden
- Confidentiality
- Privacy
- Sponsorship
- Not interested

Example 2: Concerns – Bad Timing

R: We're in the middle of dinner.

I: I'm sorry. I didn't mean to interrupt. What would be a more convenient time? (Or, I'll return at a more convenient time.)

R: I just got in, I'm tired.

I: Take a few minutes if you need to. The questions are interesting – most people enjoy the interview.

Example 3: Concerns – Burden

R: Let me think about it.

I: I know people are busy these days. This is a very important study and we want you to have whatever information you need to make your decision. Do you have any questions that I can answer right now?

Example 4: Concerns – Time Burden

R: This takes 20 minutes? I just don't have that kind of time.

I: It depends on your answers. As I said, I am very familiar with the interview – I am sure we can get through it very smoothly. If you have to go, that's fine, I can make arrangements to come back, if necessary. If we can even get it started, that's helpful. (**We can always finish it at another time.**)

Example 5: Concerns – Confidentiality

R: Nobody keeps anything confidential.

I: Your information is confidential. The University of Michigan will not share any personally identified information with any agency, or your employer, other family members, neighbors or anyone. Your information will only be used for class purposes and will never be published.

Example 6: Concerns – Privacy (1)

R: I don't think people should be talking with strangers about this.

I: This research is really helpful. I suspect you will find this interesting. I have been trained to conduct this interview. Everything you say will be kept completely private. By answering these questions, you provide valuable information that helps me with my class project.

Example 7: Concerns – Privacy (2)

R: I don't want to have anyone come into my house.

I: I don't need to be in your house to interview you. I can do the interview wherever is most convenient for you – outside on your porch or at a public place (or at your work).

Example 8: Concerns – Sponsorship

R: Who is paying for this?

I: The Survey Research Center at the University of Michigan is paying for this class project.

Example 9: Concerns – Don't Do Surveys

R: I don't do surveys.

I: I understand how you feel. I don't like to be asked to do an interview all of a sudden and not know what it's about. [Then list a few purposes of the survey.]

Example 10: Concerns – Not interested

R: I'm just not interested.

I: [Try to get them to talk to you about it.] Do you have a specific question about this survey/project? There are no right or wrong or answers; this is not a test and I'm not selling anything. We just want your opinions. If this is a bad time, I can come back when it's more convenient. (**I work any day of the week.**) I only need a few minutes to explain the study to you.

Summary: Refusal Aversion Techniques

- 1. Identify source of reluctance:** *DIAGNOSE*
- 2. Use a softening statement:** *"I know what you mean ..."*
- 3. Quickly and briefly address source of reluctance:** *"I understand you are very busy. I can set an appointment ..."*
- 4. Emphasize how you will help Rs:** *"I am very familiar with this study. I am sure it will go smoothly."*
- 5. Keep it simple:** *Simple is good!*
- 6. Use your own words:** *Tailor your response to the situation/concern.*
- 7. Start screener, interview, or set an appointment:** *There are several ways to mark success.*

Round Robin Aversion Techniques

- Practice aversion techniques with your partner (the one who sits next to you)
 - One person is Interviewer
 - One person is (reluctant) *R*

